

THE SPAIN CONNECTION

INTERNATIONAL ADVISORY

Complete Guide to Buying Your Home in Spain

Costa Blanca · Alicante · Mediterranean Living

RE/MAX Inmomás · Fuster & Associates Prime Law · UCI

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01

WELCOME

Lifestyle & Connectivity

The Costa Blanca has been recognized by the World Health Organization as one of the regions with the healthiest climate on the planet.

From the vibrant city of Alicante to the elegance of Jávea, through modern Benidorm and historic Elche — every corner of the Costa Blanca offers an unparalleled quality of life. Here, the Mediterranean lifestyle isn't a luxury: it's everyday life. Open-air markets with daily fresh produce, sunset walks by the sea, dinners on terraces with ocean breezes, and an international community that makes you feel at home from day one.

Spain ranks first on Bloomberg's index of the world's healthiest countries, and the province of Alicante is its coastal jewel. With over 320 sunny days per year, a cost of living 40-60% lower than in the US or Canada or the United States, and world-class healthcare infrastructure, the Costa Blanca is the destination chosen by thousands of international families every year.



☀️
320+
SUNNY DAYS / YEAR

🌡️
18°C
AVG. ANNUAL TEMP

🏖️
218 km
COASTLINE LENGTH

TEMPERATURE COMPARISON (°C)



✈️ INTERNATIONAL CONNECTIVITY

Miami → Madrid → Alicante

8.5h	7.5h	7.5h	1h
Miami → Madrid	New York → Madrid	Toronto → Madrid	Madrid → Alicante

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02

YOUR NEW HOME

Why Alicante? Your New Home



Blue Flag Beaches

Over 200km of coastline with crystal clear waters. San Juan, Postiguet, La Granadella among best in Europe.

Mediterranean Gastronomy

Michelin-starred restaurants, fresh seafood daily, world-famous rice dishes, local wines from Alicante D.O.

Golf & Sports

7+ championship golf courses within 30 min. Sailing, diving, hiking in Sierra de Aitana.

World-Class Healthcare

Spain #1 healthiest country (Bloomberg). Public and private healthcare at fraction of US cost. Hospital Vithas in Alicante.

International Connectivity

Alicante-Elche Airport (ALC) with 150+ direct routes. AVE high-speed rail to Madrid in 2h.

Culture & Tradition

Hogueras de San Juan, Moros y Cristianos festivals. MARQ archaeological museum. Roman and Moorish heritage.

1.2M+
Expats living in Spain

N° 1
Healthiest country in the world (Bloomberg)

€150K
Average entry price Costa Blanca

> *"Moving to Alicante was the best decision we ever made. The quality of life here is simply unmatched."*
>
> — Sarah & Michael, Texas, USA

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03

FINANCIAL REALITY

Cost Comparison & Financial Reality

Your US dollar or Canadian dollar goes significantly further on the Costa Blanca. It's not just about price — it's about a superior quality of life at a fraction of the cost.

ITEM	🇪🇸 SPAIN	🇺🇸 NY / MIAMI	SAVINGS
Private Health Insurance	€80–150 /mo	$500–1,500 /mo	~85%
Gourmet Dinner for Two	€35–60	$100–200	~70%
HOA / Community Fees	€40–100 /mo	$400–1,200 /mo	~90%
Annual Property Tax (IBI)	€300–900 /yr	$4,000–12,000 /yr	~92%
Quality 3BR Home	from €250,000	$900,000+	~72%

40–60%

Savings on your cost of living

> *"With the same retirement or remote work budget, on the Costa Blanca you live with a significantly superior standard of living."*



💶 Purchase Cost Breakdown — Costa Blanca (Valencia)

🏠 Resale Property

Purchase price	€150,000
ITP Transfer Tax: 9%	€13,500
Notary fees	€1,500
Registry fees	€700
Utilities transfer	€500
Solicitor's fees	€1,495+IVA
ESTIMATED TOTAL	**€168,009**

🏗️ New-Build Property

Purchase price	€150,000
VAT: 10%	€15,000
Stamp Duty: 1.4%	€2,100
Notary fees	€1,500
Registry fees	€700
Utilities	€500
Solicitor's fees	€1,500+IVA
ESTIMATED TOTAL	**€171,615**

** Indicative figures based on current law · Source: Fuster & Associates 2026 Property Purchase Guide*

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04

STEP BY STEP

The Buying Process Step by Step

1

NIE — Foreign Identity Number

Required document for any transaction in Spain. We handle it for you.

2–4 weeks

2

Bank Account

Open a Spanish bank account to manage payments and transfers.

1–2 days

3

Search Strategy

Together we define budget, ideal location and property type.

1–2 weeks

4

Property Selection

We present a curated selection of properties matching your criteria.

1–2 weeks

5

Legal Due Diligence

Verification of liens, debts, permits and ownership by Fuster & Associates.

1 week

6

Reservation Contract

Reservation contract with 10% deposit. Legally protects both parties.

1 day

7

Notary Deed

Signing before public notary. Registration in the Property Registry.

1 day

8

Key Handover 🔑

Congratulations! Your new Mediterranean life starts here.

Same day

Estimated complete process **4–8 weeks**

** The entire process can be completed via Power of Attorney without physical presence in Spain.*

Process Quick Reference

- ✓ NIE required — processing: 2–4 weeks
- ✓ 100% remote purchase possible via Power of Attorney
- ✓ Spanish Will strongly recommended (~€350 with Fuster)
- ✓ Non-resident mortgage available up to 70% LTV
- ✓ Total acquisition costs: ~14% of the purchase price
- ✓ Vacation rental yield: 5–8% annually (Costa Blanca)

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05

LEGAL PATHWAYS

Residency, Visas & Legal Pathways

Spain offers multiple legal pathways for citizens of the United States, Canada and other countries to establish legal residency. Our legal team at Fuster & Associates guides you through the entire process.

Digital Nomad Visa

For remote workers

Target	**Remote workers / freelancers**
Duration	**1 year (renewable to 3)**
Min. income	**~€3,024 /mo**
Tax benefit	**Beckham Law — flat 24% rate**
Work requirement	**Max 20% clients in Spain**
Family	**Includes spouse & children**

Non-Lucrative Visa

For retirees / passive income

Target	**Retirees / passive investors**
Duration	**1 year (renewable 2+2)**
Min. income	**~€28,800 /yr**
Employment	**Cannot work in Spain**
Health insurance	**Private required (no co-pay)**
Family	**Includes spouse & children**

Other Residency Pathways

Entrepreneur Visa: to launch a business in Spain. **Family Reunification:** if you have EU citizen family. **Dual nationality agreement:** citizens from Hispanic American countries can apply for citizenship after 2 years of legal residency.

Key Requirements for Your Visa Application

1. Private health insurance: Full coverage in Spain with zero co-pays or waiting periods.

2. Background check: Apostilled certificate (Hague) with sworn Spanish translation.

3. Proof of income/funds: Bank statements, remote contracts or pension records per visa type.

4. NIE & registration: Full appointment and file coordination with Fuster & Associates.

All visa processing managed by

Fuster & Associates

Attorneys specialized in immigration and real estate law

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06

ACQUISITION COSTS

Taxation & Acquisition Costs

When buying a property in Spain, understanding the costs associated with the transaction and recurring taxes is essential. Here we break down all costs so there are no surprises.

Purchase Cost Breakdown (Resale Property)



ITP — Property Transfer Tax (10%) **AJD** — Documented Legal Acts Tax (1.5%) **Notary** — Notary and registry fees (~1.5%)

Legal — Attorney fees (~1%)

~14% of purchase price in total costs

New Build Properties

For new build properties, ITP is replaced by VAT (10%) + AJD (1.5%). Total cost is similar (~12.5-14%).

Annual Recurring Taxes

IBI — Property Tax (Municipal)

Equivalent to municipal property tax. Calculated on cadastral value (much lower than market value). Typical range on Costa Blanca:

€250–800 /year

IRNR — Non-Resident Income Tax

Imputed income tax (if property is not rented). Calculated as 1.1% of cadastral value × 24% tax rate. Typical result:

€100–350 /year

US–Spain Double Taxation Treaty

The bilateral treaty between the United States and Spain prevents double taxation. Taxes paid in Spain can be credited against your US federal return via the **Foreign Tax Credit (IRS Form 1116)** included in your 1040 filing. Consult with your tax advisor in both countries to optimize your strategy.

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07

ALLIED PARTNERS

Value Ecosystem & Allied Partners

You won't be alone. We've built a strategic alliance with the best professionals in each area so your buying experience is smooth, secure and worry-free.

RE/MAX Inmomás → Fuster & Associates → Banco UCI

RE/MAX Inmomás

Comprehensive real estate advisory: property tours, market analysis, expert negotiation and personalized support. 30+ years, 115+ agents, 4 offices on the Costa Blanca.

Fuster & Associates

Complete legal due diligence, NIE & visa processing, purchase contracts, tax optimization, inheritance planning and Spanish Will. 25+ years and 20,000+ international clients served.

Banco UCI

Non-resident mortgages up to 70% LTV. Pre-approval in 48 hours. Competitive rates (fixed and variable). 100% digital process with English and Spanish support.

What Does Our 360° Support Include?

1. Property Curation & Negotiation

Expert filtering of the entire Costa Blanca market (new build and resale), live virtual or in-person tours, and dedicated buyer representation.

2. Full Legal & Tax Protection

Registry and urban planning audit, NIE acquisition, Power of Attorney for remote closing, contract review, and notary representation.

3. International Financial Structuring

Complimentary 48-hour mortgage feasibility study with Banco UCI, Spanish bank account setup, and currency exchange optimization.

4. After-Sales & Concierge Service

Utility transfers (water, electricity, fiber internet), home and health insurance, furnishing, renovations, and annual tax filings.

A single point of contact for everything. **You focus on choosing your home. We take care of the rest.**

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08

YOUR NEXT STEP

Contact & Alliance Offices

Dear future neighbor,

Thank you for your interest in the Costa Blanca and our services. At The Spain Connection we have been helping families from around the world find their ideal Mediterranean home for years. We understand that buying a property in another country is an important decision — that's why we've created an ecosystem of professionals, supported by our sponsors (RE/MAX Inmomás, Fuster & Associates, and UCI), that accompanies you every step of the way.

Whether you're in the exploration phase or have already decided to take the leap: I'm here to help you personally. I invite you to schedule a no-obligation video call to discuss your plans and how we can make them a reality.

Jose Martínez

International Expansion Director

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Our Offices

Alicante

Carrer Doctor José Luis de la Vega, 2

03015 Alicante

Benidorm

Avinguda País Valencià, 2

03509 Finestrat

Elche

Carrer Conrado del Campo, 16

03204 Elx

Jávea

Ctra. Cap de la Nau Pla, 124, Local 5

03738 Xàbia

What happens after you contact us?

1
Video Call
No obligation call to understand your needs and budget.

2
Properties
Curated shortlist matching your profile and criteria.

3
Visit
In-person or virtual property tours on the Costa Blanca.

4
Closing
All documentation managed right through to key handover.

Fuster & Associates — Legal & Tax

www.fuster-associates.com · hola@fuster-associates.com

Ready to take the first step?

Schedule Your Free Video Call

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This guide is informational and does not constitute legal or tax advice. Consult qualified professionals before making investment decisions.